

Lester Santiago Soriano

Staff Software Engineer | Payments, FinTech, Backend Platforms

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer in Singapore with 20+ years building backend platforms for payments, fintech, digital banking, and distributed systems. Work spans online banking, payment gateways, digital wallets, cross-border remittance, card authorization, fraud detection, AML / KYC, and PCI-DSS payment processing. Now Staff Software Engineer at NTUC Enterprise Nexus after Senior Software Engineer and Team Lead roles. Hands-on in Go (Golang) microservices on Google Cloud Platform (GCP), including gRPC and Protobuf for service-to-service APIs, with earlier AWS payment-platform work, system design, API design, observability, monitoring, CI/CD, mentoring, and technical leadership. Current platforms support peak throughput of 150 TPS and millions of transactions across banking, fintech, and digital commerce.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go (Golang), Java, PHP, JavaScript, SQL

Payments and FinTech: Payment gateway, PayNow, digital wallets, remittance, card authorization, MDES, BIN lookup, merchant management, KYC, AML, fraud detection, PCI-DSS, payment processing, financial services

Backend and Architecture: Microservices, distributed systems, system design, REST APIs, gRPC, Protobuf, serverless architecture, event-driven architecture

Cloud and DevOps: Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Amazon Web Services (AWS), Kubernetes, Docker, GKE, Cloud Run, Pub/Sub, AWS Lambda, API Gateway, CI/CD, Git

Data and Observability: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Microsoft SQL Server, MongoDB, BigQuery, Datadog, monitoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer

NTUC Enterprise Nexus Co-operative Limited, Singapore | January 2025 - Present

- Build Go microservices using gRPC and Protobuf for service-to-service APIs across digital commerce platforms.
- Primary engineer for Pinelabs eVoucher platform integration: technical design, system integration, API implementation, and production readiness.
- Architected digital-voucher replacement for physical vouchers and enhanced offer / promotions services for digital commerce scalability.
- Integrated the Loyalty Management System (LMS) with core platforms to migrate loyalty while preserving data integrity.
- Partnered with Product, SRE, and engineering on system design and backend delivery for platforms supporting peak throughput of 150 TPS.

Team Lead

NTUC Enterprise Nexus Co-operative Limited, Singapore | April 2023 - December 2024

- Led a 4-person eVoucher engineering team (3 engineers + 1 lead) across platform reliability, production support, feature delivery, and B2C / B2B marketplace capabilities.
- Architected the B2C Digital Voucher Marketplace and designed the B2B fulfilment workflow, replacing manual sales processes.
- Led SAP synchronisation and financial-posting fixes, reducing recurring reconciliation failures.
- Improved backend performance with Go optimisation and Redis caching, reducing API latency during peak usage; provided mentoring and strengthened observability and incident response.

Senior Software Engineer

NTUC Enterprise Nexus Co-operative Limited, Singapore | May 2021 - April 2023

- Built payment gateway integrations with Maybank and Adyen for NTUC digital products and a BIN lookup service for card routing.
- Owned the eVoucher platform as primary engineer and served as Acting Team Lead for 1 year while remaining hands-on on Go microservices with gRPC and Protobuf.

Technologies: Go (Golang), GCP (GKE, Cloud Run, Pub/Sub), Kubernetes, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, REST APIs, gRPC, Protobuf, Datadog, microservices, payment gateway

Senior Software Developer

Red Dot Payment, Singapore | August 2018 - April 2021

- Sole engineer for end-to-end PayNow payment-provider integration and ongoing maintenance.
- Built the merchant management system and delivered PCI-DSS transaction workflows with Product and Security.
- Contributed to serverless payment processing on AWS Lambda and API Gateway; established CI/CD, code review, and Agile delivery practices.

Technologies: Go (Golang), AWS Lambda, Amazon API Gateway, REST APIs, MySQL, Redis, serverless architecture, payment gateway, PCI-DSS, CI/CD

Technical Director

MatchMove Pay Pte. Ltd., Singapore | October 2017 - July 2018

- Led remittance platform design and launch across 4 corridors: India, the Philippines, Bangladesh, and China.
- Defined microservices architecture and led monolith-to-Go migration for remittance, KYC, fraud detection, and payment processing.
- Designed Mastercard card authorization and PCI-DSS payment services; led MDES tokenized card issuance.
- Built fraud and risk detection with Go and AWS CloudSearch; integrated Dow Jones and World-Check for real-time AML / compliance screening.

Senior PHP Developer

MatchMove Pay Pte. Ltd., Singapore | December 2015 - October 2017

- Developed payment-platform backend services in PHP and Go and implemented a multi-pocket, multi-currency digital wallet.
- Ran code reviews and Git workflows and served as technical liaison across multi-country engineering teams.

Technologies: Go (Golang), PHP, MySQL, Git, REST APIs, digital wallets, microservices, KYC, AML, fraud detection, Mastercard MDES, remittance, PCI-DSS

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Lead PHP Developer, MyDoc Pte. Ltd., Singapore, July 2015 - December 2015. Led healthcare backend engineering; redesigned database architecture and REST APIs (PHP, Laravel, MySQL).

Software Development Manager, Kamelean (K Digital) Pte Ltd, Singapore, March 2014 - June 2015. Hands-on backend work on a PCI-DSS cross-border ecommerce and payment platform (PHP, Symfony, payment gateway).

Lead Software Engineer / Android Developer, TheMobileGamer, Singapore, November 2012 - February 2014. Led KotaGo backend and Android app; built DAU / MAU analytics (Java, Android SDK, PHP, REST APIs).

Software Engineer, MatchMove Global Pte. Ltd., Singapore, April 2010 - November 2012. Built the first-generation digital wallet later used by MatchMove Pay; integrated PayPal and other payment providers; mentored 2 junior engineers (PHP, Kohana, MySQL).

Software Engineer, Security Bank Corporation, Makati, Philippines, January 2007 - March 2010. Developed DigiBanker corporate online banking, billing presentment, SSS real-time payments, and two-factor authentication (ASP, Visual Basic, Microsoft SQL Server, financial services).

Software Developer, Evenessence, June 2005 - October 2006. Delivered full-stack client web applications (Classic ASP, JavaScript, Microsoft SQL Server).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology, Saint Louis University, Baguio City, Philippines, 2000 - 2005